

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Senior Manager – Pension Investments candidate with ~7 years across pension ALM, liability-driven investment strategy, and multi-asset portfolio analytics. CFA charterholder with dual MSc; delivered stochastic ALM and LDI studies for Canadian pension funds at Ortec Finance, and holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, risk, and portfolio analytics for institutional portfolios (\$5–25bn per engagement) at Moody's Analytics. Hands-on depth in funded-status analysis, liability hedging, derivative overlays, VaR/CVaR portfolio optimization, and Python-driven investment analytics.

CORE SKILLS

Pension ALM & Funded-Status Analytics • Asset Allocation (SAA / TAA) • Liability-Driven Investing & Derivative Overlays • Portfolio Construction & Risk Measurement • Investment Performance & Risk Monitoring • VaR / CVaR & Risk Decomposition • Stochastic Scenario Modelling • Python, SQL & Advanced Excel • Strategy & Mandate Evaluation

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director – Modelling Services (Investment & ALM Risk Lead)

Toronto, May 2023 – Present

Portfolio Risk Monitoring & Investment Analytics

- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and portfolio-risk outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios ranging \$5–25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative) – independently reviews curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Reviews aggregation logic translating security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics used in performance monitoring, asset allocation, and funded-status reporting.
- Validates derivatives pricing across rates, FX, and inflation, and cross-checks sensitivities used in liability hedging and derivative overlay strategies at portfolio-level aggregates.

Liability Hedging, Stress Testing & Asset Allocation Support

- Oversees duration and interest-rate risk analytics under parallel and non-parallel shocks, applied to funded-status sensitivity and liability-hedging portfolio design.
- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – underpinning liquidity, hedging, and asset allocation decisions across ALM horizons.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed liquidity gap analytics (T+1 through multi-year) enabling funding, refinancing, and allocation decisions for institutional mandates.

Investment Governance & Reporting

- Member of the model governance committee – participates in methodology review, benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered investment analytics.
- Serves as escalation point on client-critical analytical issues; interfaces directly with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders on portfolio construction and risk questions.
- Re-engineered manual Excel-driven investment workflows into scalable, auditable Python analytics pipelines; prepared analytical summaries and investment memos on rate exposure, scenario impacts, and portfolio sensitivities for senior stakeholders.

Client Service Specialist – Investment Analytics Platforms

Toronto, May 2022 – May 2023

- Led onboarding for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and investment consultants on the PFaroe DB (pension/ALM analytics) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms.
- Advised pension and institutional investment teams on asset, liability, and ALM configurations; validated model outputs post-deployment and translated investment-team requirements into product/development work.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation programs for Canadian and international insurers, aligning actuarial liability, investment, and reporting workstreams.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on governance documentation and milestone delivery.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Investment Strategy

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors – analyzed funded status, duration mismatch, and long-term investment risk under base and stressed environments.
- Advised pension clients on Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) and Tactical Asset Allocation (TAA), evaluating public and private mandates against liability objectives; presented findings to investment committees on-site.
- Conducted liability-driven investment (LDI) analysis on duration, currency, and inflation hedging, and modelled derivative overlay and leverage strategies alongside all major asset classes.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization using VaR and CVaR via Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition, risk budgeting, and near-optimal frontier analysis to test robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators to assess interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk impacts on funded status and long-term portfolio outcomes.
- Led onboarding and the ALM study for the University Pension Plan (UPP) three-plan JSPP merger – on a team of three, modelled funding policy dynamics and evaluated duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016